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/ClaudeAI × Search in r/ClaudeAI

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r/ClaudeAI • 1mo ago
u/nano-zan

How can I avoid everything having an issue?

Question about Claude models

Hey there,

I use claude cowork daily on the pro plan. My default model is Sonnet 5 and 4.6.

One thing that really annoys me is that in almost every response, claude tries to find an issue "worth noting".

It will typically frame it as:

"One caveat though...", "However one issue...", "One thing worth your attention..".

And very often it isnt really an issue, it just seems like the model are made to find an issue every time and flag it. It gets really tiring to look at.

I have tried to play around with Sonnet vs Haiku and adjusting the effort of the models, but it keeps happening.

Anyone who can help with what I can do to avoid this? But still without losing flagging of serious issues in my work.

14 41

anthropic-ai • Ad

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ClaudeAI-mod-bot App MOD • 1mo ago • Stickied comment
Wilson, lead ClaudeAI modbot

TL;DR of the discussion generated automatically after 30 comments.

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"scope creep and endless yapping."

The community's advice is to be direct and persistent. Here are the top suggestions to get it to chill out:

- **Prompt it directly:** Tell it to "only flag real blockers, not hypothetical edge cases" or to roleplay as a "chill buddy." You might have to repeat this.
- **Use persistent instructions:** For a more permanent fix, users recommend adding a rule to a global `claude.md` file specifying what counts as a *real* issue (e.g., "causes data loss or a bug").
- **Switch to Claude Code:** This gives you more control with enforceable output styles and working agreements to shut down the unnecessary yapping.
- **Try the `/advisor` strategy:** A cool tip was to use `/advisor` to have a more critical model (like Opus) act as a QA checker for a less-anxious model (like Sonnet), keeping the main chat cleaner.
- **Check out the GitHub repo:** Someone even linked a repo specifically for `fixing-smartass-opus-5`.

blazarious • 1mo ago

You should try Opus 5. All it sees is problems and potential problems everywhere to the extent that I believe it has mental health issues.

But for real, I don't have any other way to deal with it than just ignoring it if I think it's not relevant.

koknesis • 1mo ago

for sure. at first i scoffed at OPs mention of sonnet but i do experience exactly the same with opus and fable.

it feels like claude would prefer to never actually finish a task and seek to fix imaginary edge cases ad infinitum until the *blast radius* of the given feature touches every aspect of the app.

loulan • 1mo ago

Maybe it's his way of procrastinating.

He's just like us.

etreydin • 1mo ago

~~*he's*~~ *'it's' just like us*

nano-zan OP • 1mo ago

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johnny_effing_utah • 1mo ago

asmiggs • 1mo ago

In Claude code I get them to surface the defects; I'll explain why they aren't important or we can defer them and then get it to write the reasoning into project documentation. Too many times I've ignored what they say, and then they'll surface them at a critical time when I'm paranoid about a deployment or whatever, which slows me down unnecessarily.

blazarious • 1mo ago

Yes, that's true. Ignoring it doesn't work reliably because it will bring it up again. In Claude Code I either tell it to ignore or to write it down somewhere. There have been occasions where I wanted it to bring it up at a later point, though.

f3xjc • 1mo ago

Joke on me. I ask them to file github issue for these automatically then my involvement become "work on 1182" on a parralel session. Then because the worker is opus 5 and reviewer is opus 5 the number of issue can only grow. But it's an interesting loop while I use fable to do most interactive work.

koknesis • 1mo ago

yeah, I'm so fed up with the endless "one more thing"s and "one more note"s when planning tasks. It seems like its dedicated to scope creep and endless yapping about it. It often feels like we'll never arrive to finalized plan as it will actively look for new things to "clear up" even when they are completely irrelevant.

I have to actively instruct it to stick to the defined scope and shut up when i provide the answers to the initial set of questions.

nano-zan OP • 1mo ago

Did you do that in the global instructions?

koknesis • 1mo ago

nah, it'll just ignore them as most other global "instructions" i try to give it. i have to actively do it in every other task.

i have no real permanent solution to this. i'm just emphasizing here that i do experience this all the time and and its driving me nuts.

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User preferences seem to be worthless these days. Almost better to just put it in that specific chat. Shit, maybe a skill that just incorporates it every time we start, but the prompt constraints will drift as the chat gets longer.

Anthropic needs to unfuck this. I've been writing off the ChatGPT knob slobbing as bots, but they're starting to get my attention.

FunOwl2026 • 1mo ago

The last few weeks that mf acts like a person. I'm like bro, you're a machine. It's ridiculous.

banecorn • 1mo ago

At the star of your sonnet sessions, use ***/advisor*** and select opus

Now your sonnet sessions can double check with opus, who's a pretty good QA, when needed.

Learn more on https://claude.com/blog/the-advisor-strategy

killit • 1mo ago

Love this! I'm still new to all this, haven't seen /advisor mentioned before though, it looks like an excellent approach, thanks 🙏

wirthmore • 1mo ago

OP: "I use claude **cowork**"

"At the star of your sonnet sessions, use */advisor*"

In which Claude mode does "/advisor" work?

u/ElevenLabs • Ad

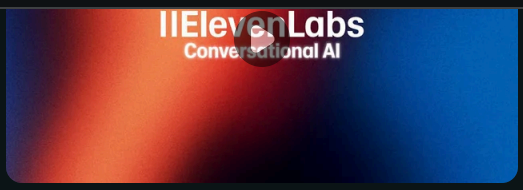
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TBT_TBT • 1mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

https://github.com/disler/fixing-smartass-opus-5

KenGuy14 • 1mo ago

The threshold idea up the thread is right, and there is a second half to it that has not come up.

First half: write the bar as something checkable rather than a tone request. Flag an issue only if it changes what I should do next, or if it makes the output wrong. Everything else goes in one line at the end under Deferred, no explanation. That is a rule. "Be less cautious" is a mood, and moods drift back within a few turns.

Second half, and it is why the rule keeps seeming not to work. Someone above said global instructions just get ignored. The version of that I have actually run into is worse: the file was never loaded at all, and nothing said so. From the outside those two look identical.

So add one line to the rules file telling it to name the files it read, in its first reply, before it does anything else. Then when the caveats come back you know within a second whether it read your rule and ignored it, or never saw it. Different problems, different fixes, and I spent weeks not knowing which one I had.

Skewwwagon • 1mo ago

I mean.. it's not a person. You don't have to fight it, just skim/skip parts you don't find useful and focus on the useful ones. You want it to flag serious mistakes but not nonsense ones, but you're the one who can decide if it's BS or not.

Trying to think, find something worth noting or "push back" is part of what makes it less sycophantic, if it's not being stubborn.

jimmyy360 • 27d ago

"make no mistakes"

grateful2you • 1mo ago

It's teaching important lesson though. You don't need to do on all its suggestions. Trust yourself more.

Fluid-Raspberry3948 • 1mo ago

try telling claude to roleplay as a chill coding buddy who only flags real problems or the convo gets boring quick, that usually cuts the fake caveats.

nano-zan OP • 1mo ago

Might try this, thanks

u/Meshyai • Ad

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Meme_Theory • 1mo ago

Its part of its harness, and is why it goes looking for issues in the first place. You can make a 'claude.md' rule to make it less frequent, but otherwise just ignore it.

Strange-Pin-2998 • 1mo ago

Switch to Claude code. In CC you can define output styles (Claude can set this up for you) which put enforceable constraints on the way it talks to you. You can also much better control working agreements, what goes into memory, use hooks and scripts to enforce stuff deterministically. It's just a better experience for doing work.

nano-zan OP • 1mo ago

Hmm interesting. Do you use it in the Claude Desktop app or in the terminal/vscode?

"gas gauge" script so my autonomous agents are aware of the weekly limits and will leave me headroom to do my own stuff during the week.

The only downside that I'm aware of in my own personal workflow with desktop is that you can't change the output style manually in the desktop app - there is no interface for it. In the terminal there's a slash command for it. So you have to ask claude to swap styles or generate them. It's just a settings.json tweak, it'll know what to do with some prompting.

nano-zan OP • 1mo ago

Awesome, thanks for the input

Amazing-Oomoo • 1mo ago

[deleted] • 1mo ago

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